

TidyTuesday Week 33

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

This week, in our ongoing quest to slam two completely unrelated economic series together and see what happens, the random number generator reached deep into the FRED barrel and pulled out a real odd couple: the Chained Consumer Price Index for services in U.S. cities, and – I promise I am not making this up – the 1-Week AMERIBOR Term Structure of Interest Rates, a series so beloved that it has since been DISCONTINUED. One of these measures how much your haircut and your streaming subscriptions cost, the other was a niche interest rate benchmark that quietly rode off into the sunset in late 2023. Naturally, we asked whether one explains the other. As one does.

And oh, what a raw regression it was. An R-squared of 0.93. Ninety-three percent! A p-value with fifteen zeros hiding behind the decimal point! If you glanced only at this, you might start drafting a Nobel acceptance speech about how services inflation is secretly governed by a defunct short-term lending rate. Truly the stuff of legend. Except, of course, both of these series were happily drifting along during an era of, you know, generally rising prices and interest rates, which is exactly the kind of shared-trend mirage this whole project exists to point at and cackle. Two lines going up together is not romance. It is just gravity for spreadsheets.

Enter the detrended version, the great destroyer of dreams. Once we strip out each series' own march-through-time, that glorious 0.93 collapses into a far more humble 0.23 R-squared. To be fair – and I say this through gritted teeth – the relationship does technically survive at a p-value of about 0.014, so it's not a total no-show like some of our trend-mirage disasters. There's a faint, wobbly little something left over after the trends are gone, a positive nudge that refuses to fully die. I would call it "intriguing" if I had any self-respect left, which after several weeks of this I do not.

But let us all take a deep, grounding breath and remember what is actually happening here: a computer picked two series out of a hat, one of which no longer exists, and we ran a straight line through them for entertainment. There is no theory, no causal story, no reason on Earth that consumer service prices should answer to a retired interest rate benchmark. Spurious correlation is the house specialty, not the exception, and a survivable-but-shrunk detrended p-value is about the most honest outcome this silly machine can produce. Enjoy the 0.014 responsibly, and please do not put it in a financial model. See you next week for more statistically meaningless companionship.

2 Date: 2026-08-10

Series ID: SUUR0000SAS

This series is titled Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Services in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1999=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1999-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01. The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: AMBOR1W

This series is titled 1-Week AMERIBOR Term Structure of Interest Rates (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Daily. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2021-06-20 and the observation end date is 2023-12-27. The popularity of this series is 2.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_AMBOR1W	R-squared:	0.930
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.927
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	319.1
Date:	Mon, 10 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	2.29e-15
Time:	12:39:09	Log-Likelihood:	-23.378
No. Observations:	26	AIC:	50.76
Df Residuals:	24	BIC:	53.27
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	-50.4524	2.976	-16.953	0.000	-56.595	-44.310
value_fred_SUUR0000SAS	0.2849	0.016	17.863	0.000	0.252	0.318

Omnibus:	3.117	Durbin-Watson:	0.261
Prob(Omnibus):	0.210	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.425
Skew:	-0.614	Prob(JB):	0.297
Kurtosis:	2.147	Cond. No.	4.58e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 4.58e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

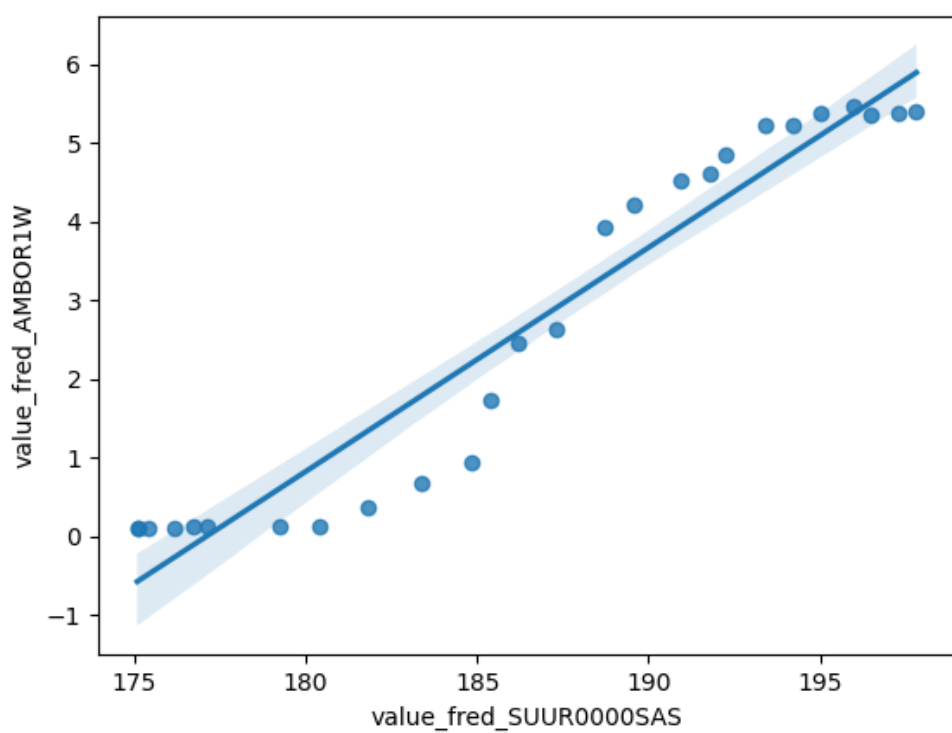


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-10

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_AMBOR1W_detrended	R-squared:	0.227
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.195
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	7.062
Date:	Mon, 10 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0138
Time:	12:39:09	Log-Likelihood:	-23.173
No. Observations:	26	AIC:	50.35
Df Residuals:	24	BIC:	52.86
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.455e-11	0.120	-1.21e-10	1.000	-0.249	0.249
value_fred_SUUR0000SAS_detrended	0.3703	0.139	2.657	0.014	0.083	0.658

Omnibus:	3.443	Durbin-Watson:	0.285
Prob(Omnibus):	0.179	Jarque-Bera (JB):	3.012
Skew:	-0.790	Prob(JB):	0.222
Kurtosis:	2.467	Cond. No.	1.16

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

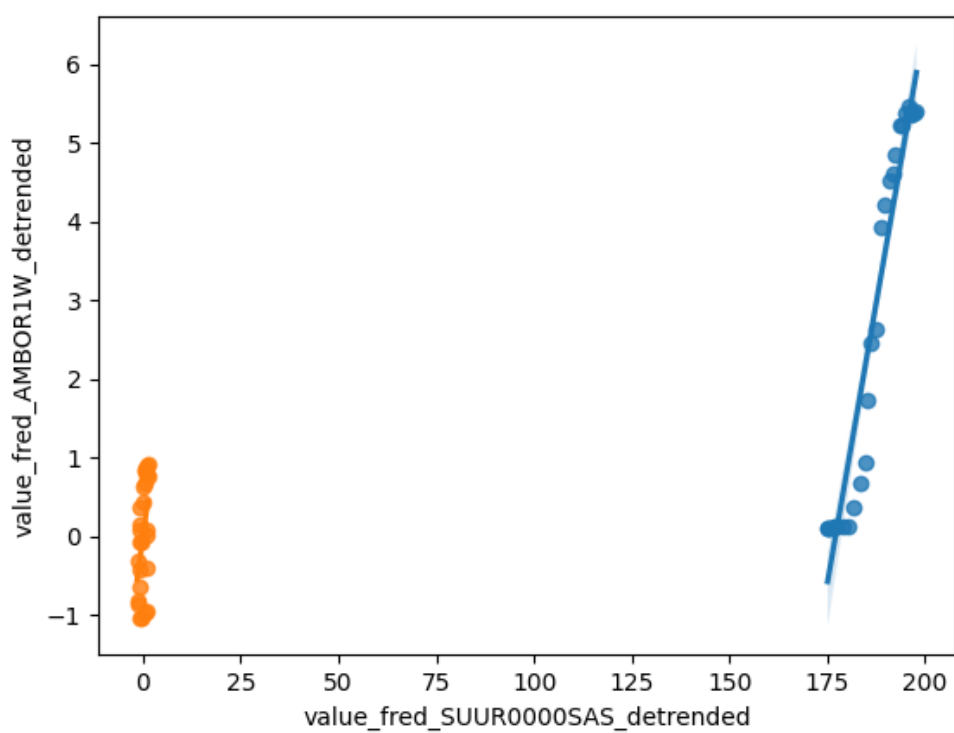


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-10